

Here's the full curation for **crossroads**, anchored to the passage phrase **"I was standing at a crossroads."** This is a very nice literal-to-figurative word: **road intersection → decision point in life**. The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

CROSSROADS

1. Passage anchor

> "At that stage of my life, I was standing at a **crossroads**, trying to decide what to study and what kind of person I wanted to become."

Passage meaning

at a crossroads = at an important point where you must choose between different future directions

處於十字路口；面臨重大抉擇；人生的關鍵轉折點

Here, the speaker is not literally standing at a road junction. The phrase describes a major decision point in life.

Practice

1. After graduation, I felt I was **at a crossroads**.

畢業後，我覺得自己正**處於人生十字路口**。

2. The company is **at a crossroads** and must decide what direction to take next.

公司正**面臨關鍵抉擇**，必須決定下一步方向。

Core meanings of CROSSROADS

2. crossroads — road intersection

= a place where two or more roads cross

十字路口；交叉路口

Examples

1. Turn left at the **crossroads**.

在**十字路口**左轉。

2. There was a small shop near the **crossroads**.

交叉路口附近有一家小店。

This is the central literal meaning.

3. at the crossroads

Literal:

= at a road junction where routes cross

在十字路口

Examples

1. We stopped **at the crossroads**.
我們在**十字路口**停了下來。
2. The sign stands **at the crossroads**.
路牌立在**交叉路口**。

Figurative decision point

4. at a crossroads — major choice

= at a stage where an important decision about the future must be made

面臨重大抉擇；處於關鍵轉折點

This is the exact passage sense.

Examples

1. She was **at a crossroads** in her career.
她的職業生涯正**處於關鍵轉折點**。
2. The country found itself **at a crossroads**.
那個國家發現自己正**面臨重大抉擇**。

5. reach a crossroads

= arrive at a point where an important choice must be made

走到十字路口；來到關鍵抉擇點

Examples

1. His career had **reached a crossroads**.

他的職業生涯已經**走到關鍵抉擇點**。

2. The project **reached a crossroads** after funding was cut.

資金被削減後，專案**來到了關鍵轉折點**。

6. stand at a crossroads

= be in a position where different future choices are possible

站在人生十字路口；面臨選擇

Examples

1. Many students **stand at a crossroads** after school.

很多學生離校後都會**站在人生十字路口**。

2. The organization now **stands at a crossroads**.

這個組織現在正**面臨重要抉擇**。

This is the passage construction.

Broader figurative meaning: turning point

7. crossroads — turning point

= important moment at which future direction may change

轉捩點；關鍵時刻

Examples

1. The merger marked a **crossroads** for the company.

合併成為公司的一個**關鍵轉捩點**。

2. The decision became a major **crossroads** in her life.

那個決定成為她人生中的重大**轉折點**。

Geographic / cultural hub

8. crossroads — place where routes, cultures, or regions meet

= place where different routes, peoples, cultures, or influences come together

****交會點；樞紐；匯合處****

Examples

1. The city became a ****crossroads of trade****.

那座城市成為貿易的****交會樞紐****。

2. The region has long been a ****crossroads of cultures****.

那個地區長久以來一直是不同文化的****交會處****。

This is an established figurative/geographic extension.

9. crossroads of trade / culture

= important meeting point of routes, commerce, or cultural influences

****貿易 / 文化交會點****

Examples

1. The port was once a ****crossroads of trade****.

那個港口以前是貿易的****重要交會點****。

2. The city developed as a ****crossroads of cultures****.

那座城市發展成不同文化的****匯合處****。

Crossroad vs crossroads

10. crossroads vs crossroad

****crossroads****

is the much more common everyday noun for an intersection and for the figurative decision-point idiom.

****crossroad****

can occur, but is much less common and often sounds literary or regional.

So learners should normally prefer:

> ****at a crossroads****

not:

> *at a crossroad*

Related forms

11. crossroad / crossroads

Literal

****十字路口；交叉路口****

Figurative

****關鍵抉擇點；轉折點****

The plural-looking form ****crossroads**** is normally treated as a singular location:

> The ****crossroads is**** ahead.

But in natural usage, speakers may also structure the sentence to avoid agreement awkwardness.

12. intersection

= place where roads cross

****交叉路口****

Examples

1. Turn right at the next ****intersection****.

在下一個****交叉路口****右轉。

2. Traffic was heavy near the ****intersection****.

****路口****附近交通很繁忙。

This is not a derivative, but an important near-synonym.

Key contrasts

13. crossroads vs intersection

****intersection****

= neutral physical road crossing

****交叉路口****

****crossroads****

= physical road crossing, but also strongly associated with figurative important choices

****十字路口；人生抉擇點****

Compare:

> Turn left at the ****intersection****.

> 在路口左轉。

> I'm ****at a crossroads**** in my career.

> 我的職業生涯正處於十字路口。

14. crossroads vs turning point

****turning point****

= moment when direction changes significantly

****轉捩點****

****crossroads****

= moment when different future directions are available and a choice must be made

****抉擇點****

So:

> turning point

> emphasizes ****change****

while:

> crossroads

> emphasizes ****choice****

15. crossroads vs dilemma

****dilemma****

= difficult choice, usually between unattractive alternatives

****兩難；困境****

****crossroads****

= major decision point, not necessarily a painful or impossible choice

****重要抉擇點****

Compare:

> I'm at a ****crossroads****.

> 我到了必須決定方向的階段。

> I'm facing a ****dilemma****.

> 我面對一個兩難問題。

16. crossroads vs milestone

****milestone****

= important point showing progress

****里程碑****

****crossroads****

= important point requiring choice of direction

****十字路口；抉擇點****

A milestone says:

> "You have come this far."

A crossroads says:

> "Which way will you go next?"

This distinction is especially relevant to the passage.

17. crossroads vs stage

****stage****

= period or phase

****階段****

****crossroads****

= critical point within that period where choices must be made

****關鍵抉擇點****

In the passage:

> “At that **stage** of my life...”

> = 人生那個階段

and:

> “I was standing at a **crossroads**...”

> = 在那個階段中正面臨重大選擇

Meaning map

The central literal image is:

several roads meeting, forcing a traveler to choose a direction

From this develops the metaphor:

Literal

crossroads

→ **十字路口**

Life/career

at a crossroads

→ **人生 / 職涯面臨重大選擇**

Turning point

reach a crossroads

→ **走到關鍵轉折點**

Cultural/geographic hub

crossroads of cultures/trade

→ **文化 / 貿易交會點**

The passage uses the life-choice metaphor:

> **standing at a crossroads**

> → **正站在人生十字路口，必須決定下一步方向**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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crossroads — literal road junction	兩條或以上道路交叉的地方；十字路口 / 交叉路口
at the crossroads — literal	位於道路交叉點
at a crossroads — figurative	處於必須對未來方向作重要選擇的階段
reach a crossroads	走到需要作重大決定的關鍵點
stand at a crossroads	正面臨幾個不同未來方向，需要作出選擇
crossroads — turning point	未來方向可能因此改變的關鍵時刻 / 轉捩點
crossroads of trade/culture	不同路線、商業或文化匯聚的交會點 / 樞紐
crossroads vs intersection	crossroads 可比喻重大抉擇；intersection 主要指實體道路交叉口
crossroads vs dilemma	crossroads = 重要選擇點；dilemma = 兩難困境
crossroads vs milestone	crossroads = 決定下一步方向；milestone = 標誌已取得的重要進展

Passage recap

> “At that stage of my life, I was standing at a ****crossroads****...”

Here:

****crossroads**** = ****a figurative point where the speaker had to choose among different future directions****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****人生十字路口****

* ****關鍵抉擇點****

* ****重要轉折點****

Natural contextual translation:

****那時候的我正站在人生的十字路口。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****at a crossroads****

= ****at an important stage where you must decide which direction to take next****

****面臨重大抉擇；處於人生十字路口****

The metaphor is very direct:

> literal crossroads

> → several roads meet

> figurative crossroads

> → several possible futures meet

In the passage, the speaker is deciding **what to study** and **what kind of person to become**, so **crossroads** emphasizes not just change, but the need to **choose a direction**.